

AYOOLA AINA

Technology Leader | Digital Lending & Banking Infrastructure | Core Banking | Fintech | BaaS

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SUMMARY

Technology leader with 9+ years of experience across core banking, digital banking, and fintech environments, spanning microfinance, mortgage, and retail banking. Currently leads engineering for a bank's payment infrastructure — architecting NestJS/TypeScript microservices over Apache Fineract, NIBSS instant payment integration, and BaaS partner integrations, while also owning core banking and back-office operations end to end (loan origination, disbursement, repayment and collections, reconciliation, digital channels). Proven track record building lending and banking technology platforms, leading cross-functional and engineering teams, driving digital transformation and process automation, and ensuring regulatory compliance, audit readiness, and platform reliability at scale.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Technology Leadership & Team Building, System Architecture & Platform Scalability, Digital Transformation Execution
- Core Banking Platforms & Integrations (MIFOS/Apache Fineract, EazyBankAX), Loan Origination, Disbursement, Repayment & Collections Workflows
- Digital Banking & Payments Infrastructure, APIs, e-Channels (USSD, Mobile, Cards), BaaS Integrations, Payment Gateways
- Regulatory Compliance, Audit Readiness, Internal Controls & Risk Management, Data Governance & Security
- Database Administration (MSSQL & MySQL), Disaster Recovery & Business Continuity Planning
- Vendor & Stakeholder Management, Process Automation & Optimization, JIRA, TestRail
- Cloud & Modern Development Frameworks: NestJS/TypeScript microservices, Redis, BullMQ, Docker, Traefik (blue-green deployment), GitHub Actions CI/CD

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BellBank MFB (Consulting)

Engineering Lead, Payment Infrastructure

Jul 2026 – Present

Lagos, Nigeria

- Lead the engineering team building BellBank MFB's payment infrastructure: a NestJS/TypeScript microservices middleware layer over Apache Fineract, migrated from legacy Java services (CBA Wallet, NIP Inflow, EasyPay Outflow).
- Own system architecture decisions, including Redis write-through balance caching and BullMQ-based async processing to improve throughput and resilience of core banking writes.
- Directed migration of the full platform from AWS to a VPS, implementing blue-green deployments via Traefik, GitHub Actions CI, health-check gates, and encrypted offsite backups to eliminate downtime risk.
- Led NIBSS Instant Payment (NIP) integration and BaaS partner integration (Bloc), including identifying and resolving API and core banking (Fineract) integration/schema discrepancies.
- Diagnosed and resolved core banking infrastructure issues affecting transaction integrity, including database connection and deployment failures impacting live payment processing.

KATSU Network Limited (SABI Africa)

Core Banking Platform & Operations Lead

Jun 2024 – Present

Lagos, Nigeria

- Led the full setup of Katsu Microfinance Bank's core banking and back-office operations from inception — account opening workflows, account structure, reconciliation models, charge rules, and reporting — delivering a seamless launch and CBN regulatory readiness.
- Own end-to-end administration of the MIFOS/Apache Fineract core banking system, optimizing performance and integration across all banking functions for 5,000+ customer accounts.
- Designed operational policies, loan origination, disbursement, and journal entry processes for retail and MSME lending, aligning platform behavior with finance and compliance requirements.

- Delivered digital transformation projects that cut manual workflows by 40%, automating backend operations and integrating third-party APIs (KYC, disbursement, SMS).
- Acted as core business decision-maker and strategy contributor, aligning technology roadmap with growth goals, regulatory timelines, and market expansion.
- Integrated SME-focused digital banking and lending products, increasing active user engagement by 20% and driving adoption of digital loan and savings products.

VFD Tech

Nov 2023 – Sept 2024

Application Support Engineer (BaaS Operations Support)

Lagos, Nigeria

- Supported transaction processing and operational continuity for Banking-as-a-Service, monitoring API and payment gateway transactions for accuracy and availability.
- Produced daily operational and transaction reports for decision-making and resolved issues affecting customer transactions across VFD Group entities.

Abbey Mortgage Bank PLC

Feb 2022 – Oct 2023

Team Lead, CBA, Database & Digital Channels

Lagos, Nigeria

- Led the core banking support team, restructuring escalation workflows with IT and operations, cutting unresolved tickets by 30%.
- Ensured availability and performance of digital banking channels (Mobile, Card, USSD, Internet Banking) and optimized MSSQL database performance through query tuning and proactive monitoring.
- Spearheaded and tested disaster recovery plans across critical infrastructure, securing business continuity, and improved bug resolution cycles by 25% via structured JIRA/TestRail workflows.

Abbey Mortgage Bank PLC

Mar 2020 – Jan 2022

Lead Network Administrator, DBA & Infrastructure Management

Lagos, Nigeria

- Managed critical banking infrastructure across multiple branches, implementing security and control measures for data integrity and regulatory compliance.
- Managed database backup, replication, and access control strategies, and supported business continuity and disaster recovery planning.

Xiaomi Technologies (Contract, Remote)

Sept 2021 – Sept 2022

Quality Assurance Engineer

Remote

- Conducted functional and regression testing on Xiaomi mobile devices; designed test plans, scenarios, and scripts, tracking defects via JIRA and TestRail.

Abbey Mortgage Bank PLC

Jun 2017 – Feb 2020

Technical Support Engineer

Lagos, Nigeria

- Delivered enterprise-wide IT support, provisioning systems and supporting e-channels platforms across departments, ensuring optimal uptime.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science (In View, expected 2029) — University of the People (California, USA)

Higher National Diploma (HND) in Computer Science (2025) — Yaba College of Technology (Lagos, Nigeria)

National Diploma in Computer Hardware Engineering (2016) — Dalewares Institute of Technology (Lagos, Nigeria)

CERTIFICATIONS

ITIL Foundation Certificate in IT Service Management — PeopleCert, 2021

AWS Database & Data Processing — Amazon Web Services, 2021

Sophos XG Firewall Administrator — Sophos, 2018